Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff AI Product Engineer | Multimodal AI, Agent Systems & Product Architecture

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with 20 years of experience building products and platforms, including approximately five years at Staff level at Shopify. Designs and ships AI-powered experiences that make complex capabilities useful to people, combining deep TypeScript/React expertise with multimodal model integration, agent orchestration, iterative evaluation, and technical leadership. Experienced taking exploratory ideas through architecture, implementation, and adoption while mentoring engineers without moving into people management.

CORE SKILLS

AI product engineering: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, multimodal generation, model routing and fallbacks, agent orchestration, AI evaluation, human-in-the-loop workflows, MCP, Pi extensions

Software and product: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, frontend architecture, reusable SDKs, API design, rapid prototyping, developer experience, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Docker, Kubernetes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–2026

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an internal multimodal creation product first started by another person, into an isomorphic TypeScript library built on **Vercel AI SDK**, consumed by web, CLI, and MCP interfaces for employee and AI-agent workflows. The platform served an estimated **hundreds of users daily** and generated **100,000+ images**.
- Designed a capability-aware model registry tracking provider limits and costs, plus asynchronous jobs, outage fallbacks, and remote polling for long-running video generation; enabled straightforward expansion from images to video, speech, and music.
- Conceived and implemented an AI-agent prototype to update heavily customized merchant email templates, reaching **90% success on a small curated benchmark** after iterative experimentation. Combined structure-aware patches, parsing and rendering checks, vision-model screenshot comparisons, and human evaluation; subsequently served as tech lead for a **six-engineer** production effort that was canceled before launch.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- Built a working multi-agent code review system with lightweight classification and routing, specialist reviews for security, accessibility, APIs, and developer experience, aggregated findings, guided tours, and diagrams; piloted with a handful of colleagues.
- Developed Pi agent tooling for low-latency multi-model safety judgments with human override, web-to-Markdown retrieval, rich editor experiences, and extensible UI surfaces for Pi IDE.
- Extended UI extensions to Shopify's Admin product detail page, implementing the first Bundles extension card. Contributed to checkout and first-party bundle workflows; mentored junior engineers and an intern.
- Developed product-data coverage calculations and rule-inheritance visualizations for multichannel mapping rules, part of a merchant-facing product shipped in Shopify Editions in 2026.

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped the developer API for sandboxed **Checkout UI Extensions**, pairing a React-based extension model with remote UI; key architectural concepts continued into the production platform.
- Helped evolve Shopify's B2B commerce capabilities after the Handshake acquisition, including business customers and payment terms.
- Contributed to first-party post-checkout upsell capabilities; named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658 (granted 2022).

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Modernized a multi-tenant B2B commerce product as part of a small frontend team, contributing to a React migration, self-service wholesale ordering, and customizable catalogs.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Built foundational frontend libraries, asset management and build tooling, cart interfaces, and two generations of checkout; supported responsive design and mentored engineers.

Earlier: Web Developer, Mindspark (2008–2009); Developer, Tyler Technologies (2006–2008); Research Assistant, University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | B.S., Computer Science